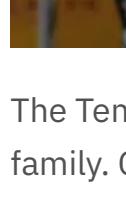




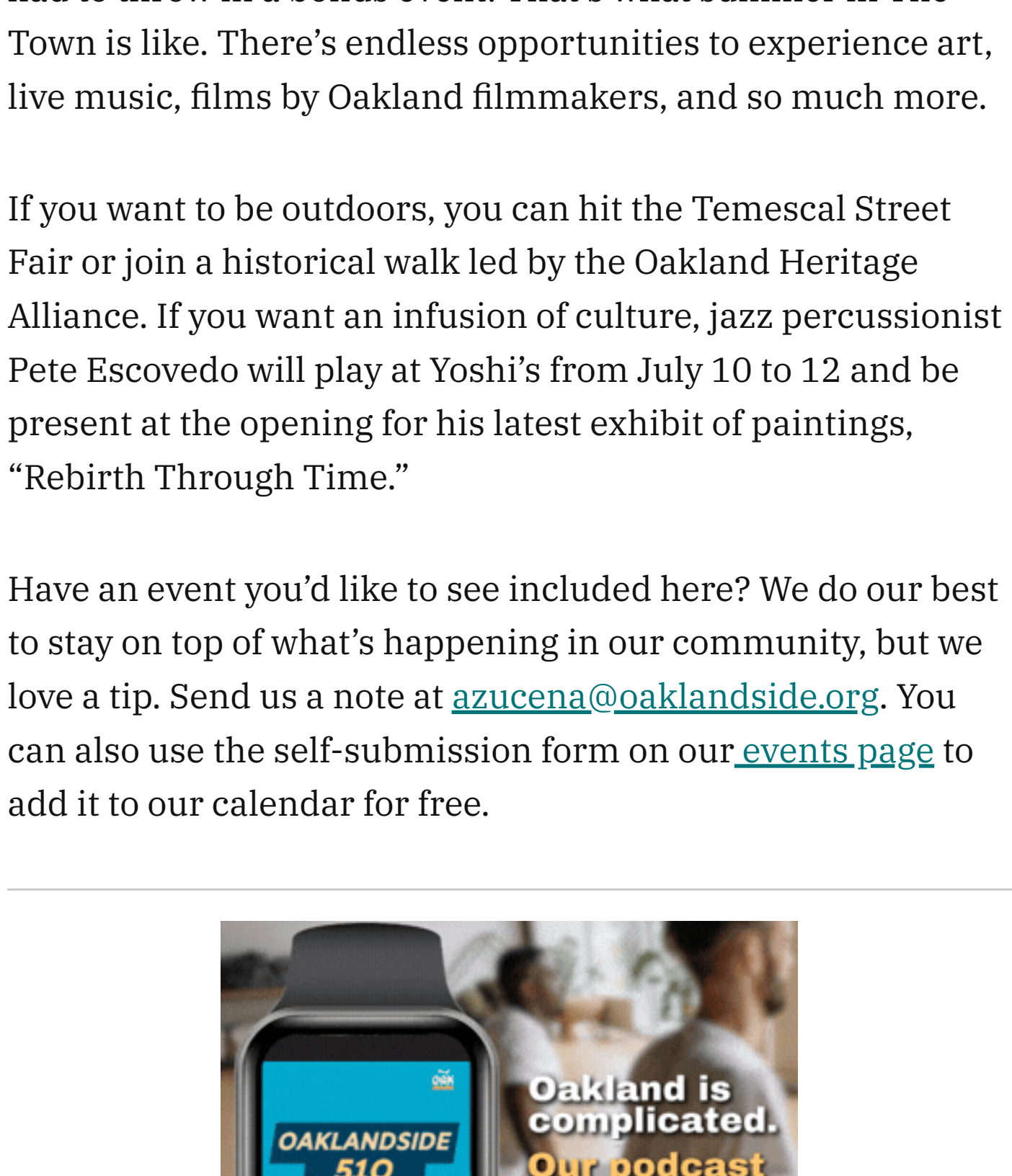
ARTS & COMMUNITY

This week in Oakland: Temescal Street Fair and the ‘Wood Street’ documentary screening at Grand Lake Theater

Other events include Pete Escovedo’s art exhibit, a walk of the historic F. M. “Borax” Smith Estate, and test your U.S History trivia at the library.



by **Azucena Rasilla**
July 8, 2026, 9:00 a.m.



The Temescal Street Fair showcases live music, an artisan market and activities for the family. Credit: courtesy of Patanisha Williams

There is so much happening in Oakland this weekend that we had to throw in a bonus event. That’s what summer in The Town is like. There’s endless opportunities to experience art, live music, films by Oakland filmmakers, and so much more.

If you want to be outdoors, you can hit the Temescal Street Fair or join a historical walk led by the Oakland Heritage Alliance. If you want an infusion of culture, jazz percussionist Pete Escovedo will play at Yoshi’s from July 10 to 12 and be present at the opening for his latest exhibit of paintings, “Rebirth Through Time.”

Have an event you’d like to see included here? We do our best to stay on top of what’s happening in our community, but we love a tip. Send us a note at azucena@oaklandside.org. You can also use the self-submission form on our [events page](#) to add it to our calendar for free.



Visit [The Oaklandside's events calendar](#) to see what else is going on!

Hot Ticket in The Town this week: 20th annual Temescal Street Fair

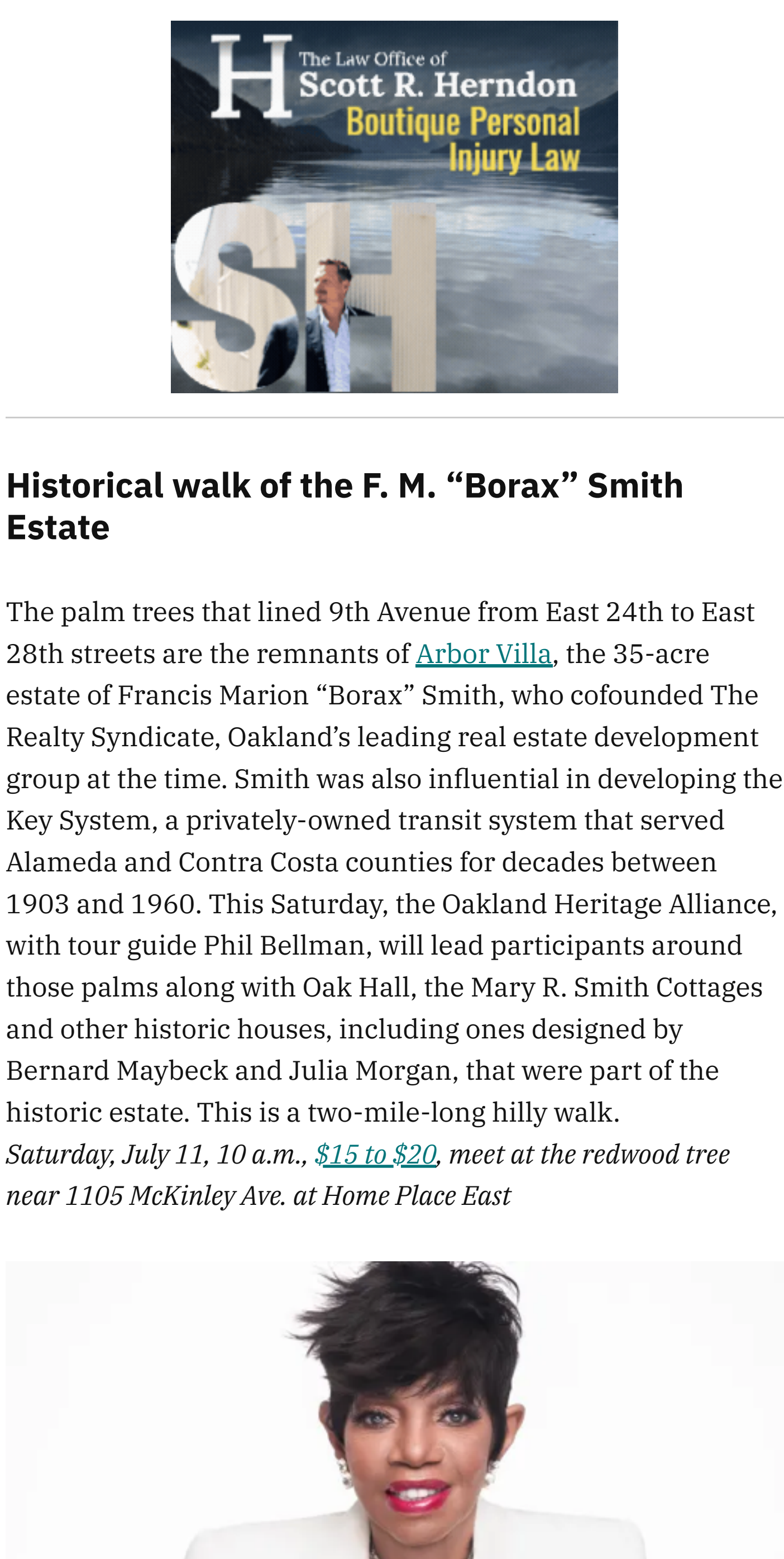
The family-friendly free festival in North Oakland will feature two music stages, including a HipHop TV stage that will honor the 60th anniversary of the Black Panther Party with a performance by SambaFunk and DJ sets by Davey D, Tabu and DC is Chillin.’ The main stage will feature performances by artists such as rapper J. Walt and singer-songwriter B. DeVeaux, both alums of Oakland School for the Arts. The festival will also include a fashion show, a TURFinc dance battle, an artisan market and more.

Saturday, July 11, 11 a.m. to 7 p.m., free, Telegraph Avenue between 44th and 51st streets

‘Wood Street’ documentary at Grand Lake Theater

This film by journalist and filmmaker Caron Creighton [follows a year in the life of Oakland's largest unhoused encampment](#) as its residents face eviction. The documentary has already sold out a screening at the New Parkway, but there are still tickets available for a screening the next day at the Grand Lake Theater.

Wednesday, July 15, 7:30 p.m., [\\$15](#), Grand Lake Theater, 3200 Grand Ave.



Pete Escovedo’s ‘Rebirth Through Time’ art opening

The legendary percussionist always comes back to his hometown to celebrate his birthday by [showcasing his artwork](#) and [playing shows at Yoshi’s](#). The exhibit of his pen and ink paintings will be on display through July 31.

Opening reception, Thursday, July 9, 5 to 8 p.m., free, The Grand Gallery Oakland, 560 2nd St.

Test your U.S. History trivia event

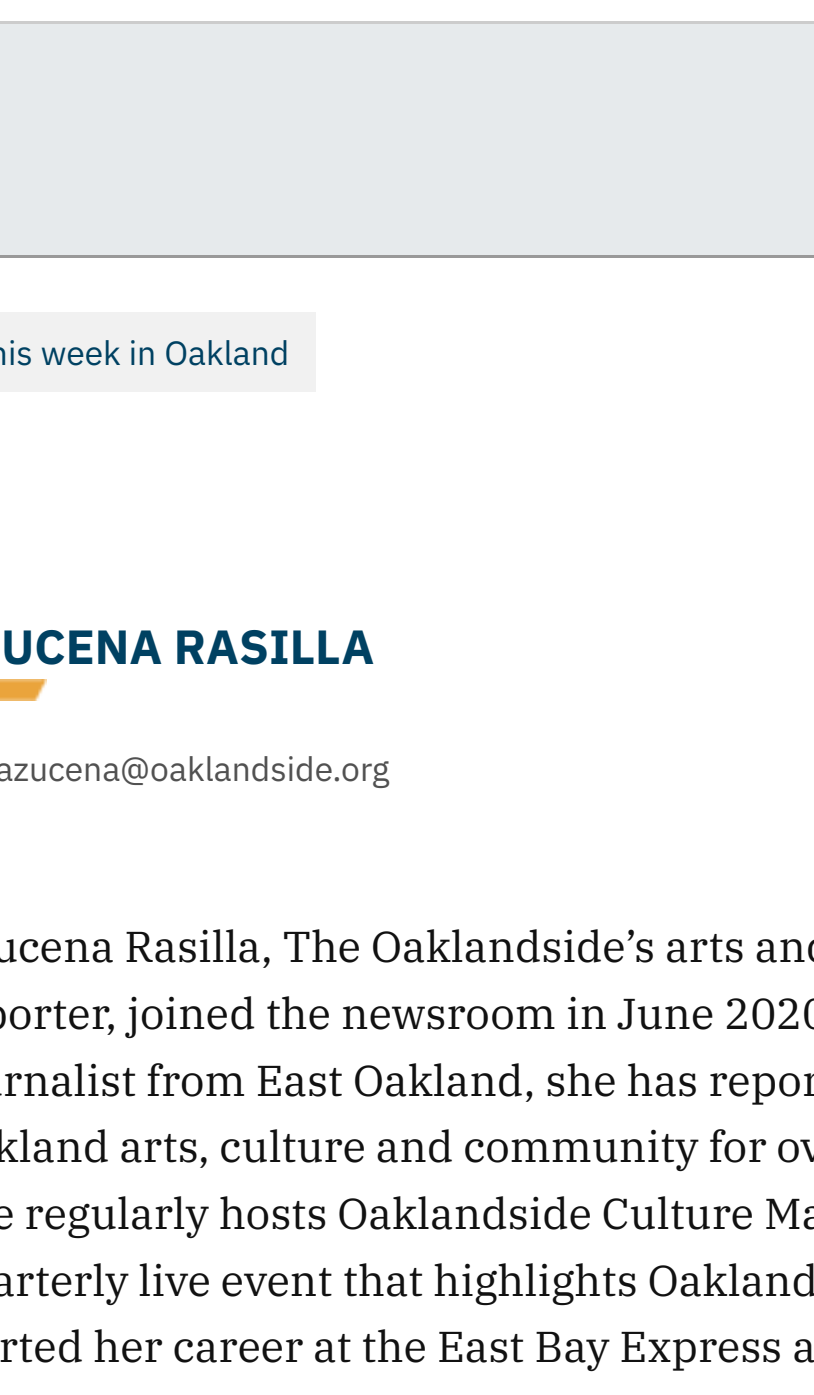
The Oakland Public Library is celebrating the country’s 250th anniversary with a special trivia event where you can test your U.S. history and civics knowledge, based on questions from the U.S. naturalization test. The winner will receive an OPL tote bag.

Saturday, July 11, 2 p.m., free, main library branch, 125 14th St.

‘House of the Dragon’ season 3 watch party

If you have been obsessing over the popular HBO series, a prequel to “Game of Thrones,” then head to Golden Ratio on Franklin Street, where you can gather with other fans eager to follow Princess Rhaenyra Targaryen’s quest for the Iron Throne. The event kicks off each Sunday with an open discussion among attendees, a screening of the previous episode, followed by a watch party for the new episode.

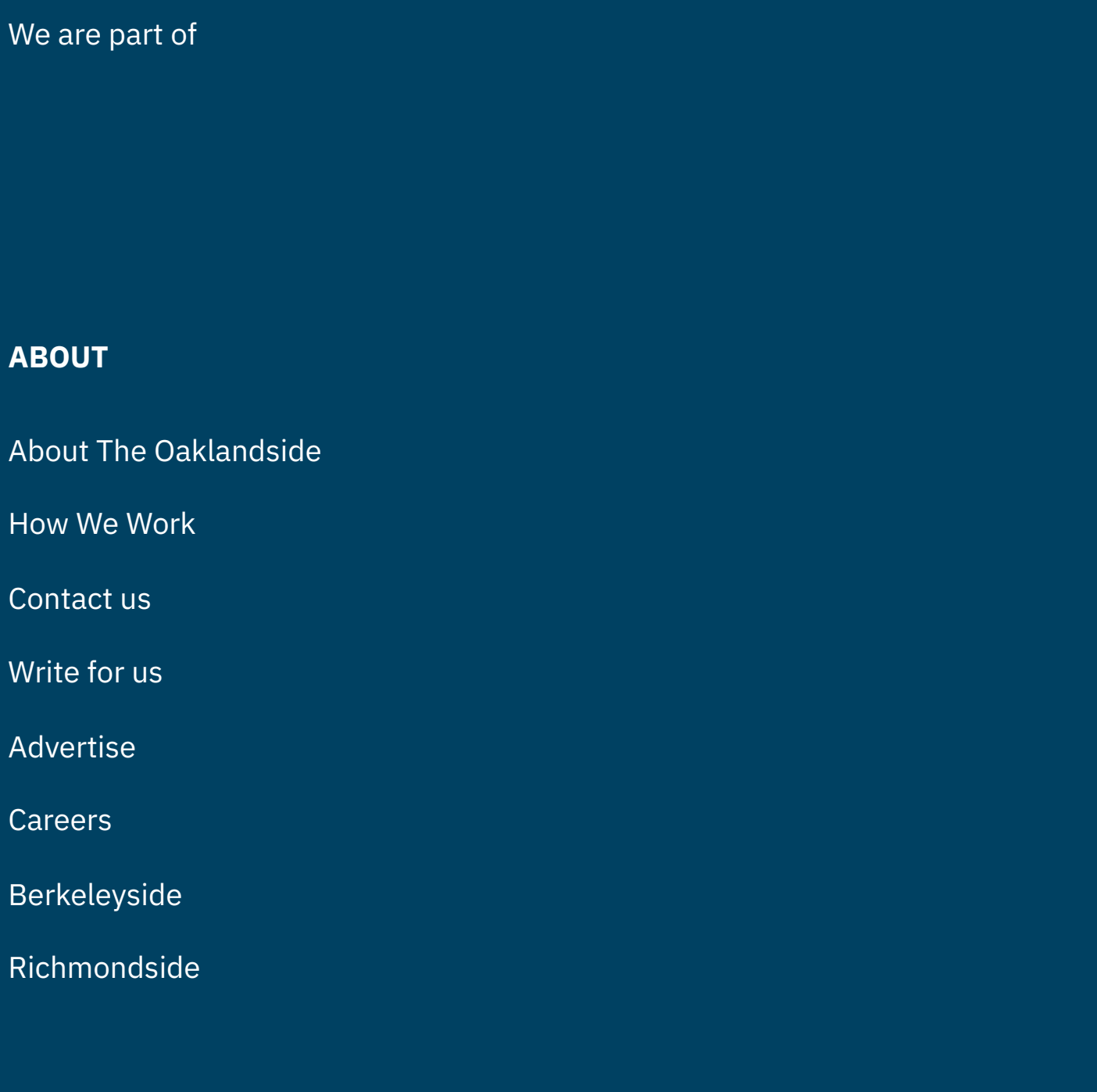
Every Sunday, 4 p.m., free, Golden Ratio, 1517 Franklin St.



Historical walk of the F. M. “Borax” Smith Estate

The palm trees that lined 9th Avenue from East 24th to East 28th streets are the remnants of [Arbor Villa](#), the 35-acre estate of Francis Marion “Borax” Smith, who cofounded The Realty Syndicate, Oakland’s leading real estate development group at the time. Smith was also influential in developing the Key System, a privately-owned transit system that served Alameda and Contra Costa counties for decades between 1903 and 1960. This Saturday, the Oakland Heritage Alliance, with tour guide Phil Bellman, will lead participants around those palms along with Oak Hall, the Mary R. Smith Cottages and other historic houses, including ones designed by Bernard Maybeck and Julia Morgan, that were part of the historic estate. This is a two-mile-long hilly walk.

Saturday, July 11, 10 a.m., [\\$15 to \\$20](#), meet at the redwood tree near 1105 McKinley Ave. at Home Place East



New York songstress Melba Moore has a singing and acting career spanning five decades since her debut album “I Got Love” was released in 1971. Credit: courtesy of Double XXposure Media Relations

Coming soon to The Town: Melba Moore at Yoshi’s

The actress and R&B singer Melba Moore, who started performing on Broadway stages in the late 1960s, recently self-published a memoir, “This Is It: Marvelous & Getting Better.” She is going on tour and will play a show in Oakland in August that will feature her classic hits “You Stepped Into My Life” and “Love’s Comin’ at Cha” as well as songs from her years on Broadway.

Wednesday, Aug. 5, 7 p.m., [\\$45 to \\$79](#), 510 Embarcadero West

...We rely on your support

Hey, we know that most readers only scan a headline and a couple of paragraphs. Thank you for reading to the end of our story. Since you clearly appreciate the in-depth approach we take in reporting the stories that matter to Oaklanders, please consider chipping in to supercharge our newsroom.

Yes, I want to support The Oaklandside!

Send a note to the Oaklandside newsroom. *

See an error that needs correcting? Have a tip, question or suggestion? Drop us a line.

0 of 600 max characters

Email *

Name

Phone

Submit

TAGGED: [This week in Oakland](#)

AZUCENA RASILLA

azucena@oaklandside.org

Azucena Rasilla, The Oaklandside’s arts and community reporter, joined the newsroom in June 2020. A bilingual journalist from East Oakland, she has reported on Oakland arts, culture and community for over a decade. She regularly hosts Oaklandside Culture Makers, a quarterly live event that highlights Oakland creatives. She started her career at the East Bay Express and her work has appeared in the San Francisco Chronicle, KQED, Eater and Curbed.

More by Azucena Rasilla

We are part of

ABOUT

About The Oaklandside

How We Work

Contact us

Write for us

Advertise

Careers

Berkeleyside

Richmondside

JOIN US

Get our newsletters

Donate

OUR MISSION

We’re journalists for Oakland. We amplify community voices, share information resources, and investigate systems, not just symptoms. Learn more

© 2026 Cityside. All Rights Reserved

Powered by Newspaper

Policies